TOPIC 2 · AUSTRALIA'S PLACE IN THE GLOBAL ECONOMY

Australian Bureau of Statistics
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Goods trade surplus jumps to $2.8 billion as imports fall

> Australia's surplus on goods trade widened sharply in September. Exports of fuels, metals and meat rose, while imports fell, led by a big drop in gold.

WHAT HAPPENED

- The seasonally adjusted goods surplus rose $2,642m to **$2,826m**, up from a revised $184m in August.
- Exports rose $1,090m (2.3%) to $48.4b, led by other mineral fuels (+$502m) and metals excluding gold (+$382m).
- Rural exports rose 3.6%, helped by an 11.3% (+$243m) rise in meat exports.
- Imports fell $1,551m (3.3%) to $45.6b. Non-monetary gold made up −$1,096m of the fall, and imports of both capital and consumption goods also eased.
- The October figures are due on 3 December.

Balance on goods: exports of goods minus imports of goods; part of the current account

Non-monetary gold: gold traded as a commodity; volatile flows that can swing the monthly balance

$2.83b
Goods surplus in September (seasonally adjusted)

+2.3%
Rise in goods exports, to $48.4b

−3.3%
Fall in goods imports, to $45.6b

BAR CHART

Goods surplus, seasonally adjusted ($m)



The surplus jumped because **exports rose and imports fell at the same time**. Falling imports of capital and consumer goods may also be a sign of **weaker domestic demand** as interest rates rise.

Exam angle: Link the goods balance to the **current account** (CAD = goods and services balance + primary income + secondary income). A larger goods surplus narrows the CAD, but the primary income deficit is usually much bigger.

SYLLABUS LINK

Topic 2 – Trends in the value and composition of Australia's trade; the balance on goods and services and the current account.

TRY THIS

1. Outline the main factors behind the larger goods surplus in September 2026. **(3 marks)**
2. Explain how a larger goods surplus affects Australia's current account deficit. **(4 marks)**

Read more: abs.gov.au/statistics/economy/international-trade/international-trade-goods/sep-2026

Summary written in our own words for classroom use